

StartupSutra Editorial Bible v1.0

22 July 2026

The Operating System for Every Story We Publish

1. Manifesto

Vision: Build India's most trusted startup storytelling publication.

Mission: Decode businesses through cinematic storytelling and rigorous research—not headlines.

Reader Promise: Every story should leave readers with one business lesson they can remember and apply.

We Are: Editorial, analytical, visual, evidence-led.

We Are Not: News aggregation, clickbait, rumours, motivational quotes, investment advice.

Non-Negotiable: If a story doesn't make founders think differently, we don't publish it.

2. Audience Blueprint

Primary audience: Aspiring founders, startup operators, MBA students, business professionals and angel investors (20–38 years, India-first).

Psychographics: Curious, ambitious, analytical, lifelong learners.

Emotional triggers: Curiosity, surprise, aspiration, validation and practical learning.

Every post is written for one intelligent reader—not for everyone.

3. Editorial Calendar

Sunday: Case Study

Monday: Startup Failure

Tuesday: Marketing Breakdown

Wednesday: Seed Signal

Thursday: Growth Capital

Friday: Exit Stories

Saturday: Founder Framework

Monthly: StartupSutra Watchlist

Quarterly: Industry Deep Dive.

4. Storytelling Framework

Every story follows:

1. Hook
2. Context
3. Conflict
4. Turning Point
5. Outcome
6. Lesson

Rule: Every slide must either increase curiosity, raise stakes, reveal something unexpected or resolve the story.

5. Research Framework

Research founder, product, market, customers, competitors, business model, funding, investors, hiring, reviews, growth signals, risks and public sources before writing.

No assumptions. Separate facts, analysis and opinion.

6. Visual Language

Every story must include: Founder, product, timeline, chart, key metric, logos and documentary visuals.

Black background. Premium typography. Maximum 35 words per slide. Every reel changes visuals every 2–3 seconds.

7. Workflow

Research → Daily Creative Brief → Storyboard → Design → Review → Publish → Analytics Review.

Publishing:

08:00 Carousel

09:00 Reel 1

13:00 Reel 2

8. Editorial Standards

Tell stories, not facts. Show evidence, not opinions alone. Never publish rumours. Never recommend investments. Every claim should be backed by publicly available information.

9. Watchlist Policy

Monthly StartupSutra Watchlist scores startups on Founder, Product, Market, Traction, Execution, Timing and Defensibility.

Disclaimer: Watchlist scores are StartupSutra's editorial opinion based on publicly available information. They are not investment advice or predictions.

10. Success Metrics & Decision Filter

Primary KPIs: Retention, watch time, saves, shares, comments and follows.

Before publishing ask:

- Would I stop scrolling?
- Is the story memorable?
- Is every slide necessary?
- Is the lesson actionable?
- Does this strengthen StartupSutra's credibility?

Final Principle: We don't report startup news. We decode businesses.